November 3, 2026 — San Ramon ballot sheet

Voter: San Ramon 94582. **Framework:** fairness-not-equity. **Last verified:** Oct 14, 2026.

One voter's guide under that framework. Not a prediction, and not an instruction to vote. Scores, where a race was scored, are the small numbers under the pick.

Governor Hilton MEDIUM
62.45 vs 42.15
Hilton wants to cut income and gas taxes, cut fees on smaller homes, and limit lawsuits that stop construction. Becerra would freeze utility and insurance rates and has not ruled out new taxes. These are campaign plans, not laws either man has passed, so this stays Medium.

Lieutenant governor Romero MEDIUM
58.00 vs 43.35
The clear difference is school choice, which this voter reads as families getting to decide. Ma's listed backers are the labor federation, the building trades, and AFSCME, and no reform plan turned up for her.

Secretary of state Wagner MEDIUM
57.35 vs 49.00
Wagner wants voters to show ID, the same idea as a Yes on Proposition 39: one rule for everyone. Weber's record is mail ballots for all and wider access, which was not counted against her.

Controller Morgan MEDIUM
60.25 vs 51.65
Morgan is running to expose fraud, and he founded an investment firm. That private-sector money experience is what this voter wants in the state's accountant. Cohen urges careful spending, but a matching audit plan was not found.

Treasurer Hawks LOW
51.25 vs 47.40
Hawks says she would be an independent check, but no plan for the state's investments or debt turned up. Kounalakis voted against UC and CSU tuition hikes and spent years raising money for Democrats. The lead is thin. I am not confident here.

Attorney general Bonta MEDIUM
62.65 vs 43.15
Bonta has spent his term enforcing laws that make cities allow new housing. Gates fought those laws as Huntington Beach city attorney. His promise of equal justice still fits, and it does not outweigh that housing record. This stays Medium because the source is news and the candidates' own words, not the court files.

Insurance commissioner Allen MEDIUM
48.00 vs 37.55
Kim wants a state-run disaster insurer, paid by insurance companies, plus a bigger public auto program. Allen wants more staff for complaints and loans for wildfire safety, with private insurers still selling the policies. Neither has run an insurance company.

Board of Equalization, District 2 Pimentel MEDIUM
62.30 vs 45.85
Pimentel says he would end the sales tax on food, which takes a bigger share from people with less money. Lieber's listed backers include the Democratic Party, SEIU, and the teachers union. Both sides are campaign statements, so this is Medium.

U.S. House, District 10 Frese MEDIUM
55.60 vs 43.00
Frese would cut deficit spending, limit how long members of Congress serve, and ease rules that slow building. DeSaulnier's campaign stresses workers' rights, health care, and a progressive approach, and also talks about tax cuts for families.

State Assembly, District 16 Bauer-Kahan MEDIUM
50.70 vs 42.50
Rubay opposes state rules that push denser housing into the suburbs. That works against this voter's preference for more homes. Bauer-Kahan's campaign, as a San Ramon news guide describes it, does not make that argument. The guide is thinner than the statewide sources.

Superintendent of public instruction Shaw MEDIUM
56.90 vs 42.35
Shaw says schools should get back to academic basics. Barrera's priority is more school funding and an easier path into teaching, and the teachers union's endorsement is what made him widely known. The office is nonpartisan, and in 2027 a governor-appointed commissioner takes over the department.

Judicial retention No pick
No pick. Supreme Court justices Kelli M. Evans and Joshua Groban are on every ballot, along with the First Appellate District justices named on the certified list. Their opinions were not read. This is not a vote to keep them and not a vote to remove them.

CHECK YOUR SAMPLE BALLOT

ZIP 94582 is not one council district, one school area, or one services-district division. No confidence label on these.

San Ramon mayor No pick
No pick. The citywide ballot lists Emma Chigbu, Mark H. Armstrong, and Paschalis Ntatsos. Job titles are not a record, and the candidates' answers were not in the page used here.

City Council, District 2 No pick
No pick, and only if your address is in District 2: Chirag Kathrani or Richard J. Adler. Districts 1 and 3 are not on this ballot. Check your sample ballot.

City Council, District 4 No pick
No pick, and only if your address is in District 4: Jeffrey Joh or Marisol Rubio. A 94582 home is in one council district, not both.

San Ramon Valley Unified, Area 5 No pick
No pick, and only if you live in Trustee Area 5: Rachel Hurd or Joel Woods. A local guide describes Area 5 as eastern and southeastern San Ramon, around Dougherty Valley. Area 1 (Amanda Butland) and Area 4 (Susanna Ordway) have one name each. Many 94582 addresses are not in Area 5.

Dublin San Ramon Services District, Division 2 No pick
No pick. Kismat Kathrani and Donald Downey are the names if your address is in Division 2. This ZIP was not matched to a division. If the race is not on your sample ballot, you do not have it.

MEASURES

Proposition 1 No MEDIUM
The state would borrow $11.25 billion, mostly for affordable housing, plus help for veterans buying a home, farm, or mobilehome. Taxpayers pay that debt back for years. More housing is a real reason to vote yes, which is why this is Medium rather than a firmer no.

Proposition 2 Yes MEDIUM
This raises the cap on the state's rainy-day fund from 10 percent of tax revenue to 20 percent. That is savings, not a new tax. It also makes it easier to declare a budget emergency, which keeps this at Medium.

Proposition 3 No MEDIUM
The extra tax on high incomes, now set to end in 2031, would become permanent and keep about $5 billion to $15 billion a year, mostly for schools. A tax that never expires fails the bar this voter sets. The payers are high earners, so this is Medium.

Proposition 4 No MEDIUM
Government could spend public money on campaigns for office. You would help pay for candidates you oppose. Supporters say that would make candidates less dependent on big donors, which is why this is Medium.

Proposition 5 Yes LOW
If voters recall a statewide officer, they would no longer pick the replacement on the same ballot. The job would be filled the way a vacancy usually is. That drops a messy side election. I am not confident. Push back if you want the replacement chosen the same day.

Proposition 37 Yes LOW
Up to $25 billion in loans would help some buyers with a down payment. The official summary says the buyers pay the money back, not the state, unlike Proposition 1. The setup is new, so this is Low. Push back if a taxpayer backup is hiding in the fine print.

Proposition 38 No MEDIUM
The state would borrow $8.4 billion for disease research, about $500 million a year for 25 years, paid by taxpayers. Drugs developed with the money would have to be sold cheaper in California. That purpose is real, so this is Medium rather than a firmer no.

Proposition 39 Yes MEDIUM
Every voter would show a government ID at the polls, or the last four digits on a mail ballot, and the state would have to give an ID to anyone who asks. One ID rule for everyone matches this voter's preference for the same rules for all. Cost, and the chance a legal voter is turned away, keep this at Medium.

Proposition 40 No MEDIUM
A one-time tax of up to 5 percent would hit assets over $1 billion, and that money would sit outside the state's spending limit. A new tax plus a way around the spending cap fails here. A San Ramon news guide calls it union-sponsored. It is one time and hits a narrow group, so this is Medium.

Proposition 41 Yes HIGH
New special taxes would need an audit of the programs they pay for, before the vote and after. New state taxes could not dodge the spending limit, including taxes on the same ballot. It does not create a tax, and nothing of similar weight points the other way.

Proposition 42 Yes HIGH
The state could not add a new tax on things people own, including retirement accounts and investments, or certain taxes that reach backward, including measures on this ballot. Less revenue later is the point of the rule, not a reason to vote no.

Proposition 43 Yes MEDIUM
Starting in 2027, a local special tax would need a two-thirds vote, including taxes placed by voters, with some exceptions. A higher bar for new local taxes matches this voter. The same hurdle would bind citizen initiatives, not only city halls, which keeps this at Medium.

Proposition 44 Yes LOW
Certain nonprofit clinics would have to spend at least 90 percent of revenue on the service itself, with penalties if they fall short. That pushes money toward care. Whether 90 percent is a workable line was not shown, and a local guide says the measure is union-backed, with leftover penalties usable for clinic-worker training. I am not confident.

Proposition 45 Yes MEDIUM
Environmental review would speed up for some housing, roads, water, health, and clean-energy projects, with shorter court fights. Faster housing review matches this voter's preference for more homes. Narrower court review is a fairness concern the other way, so this is Medium.

Measure RTM No MEDIUM
Contra Costa would add a half-cent sales tax for 14 years, about $980 million a year, to avoid big transit cuts and to pay for safety, repairs, and oversight. This voter is skeptical of a new sales tax used to fill an operating hole. Riders and the repairs are a real benefit, so this is Medium.

Not on this ballot: State Senate District 9 (next in 2028), county supervisor, district attorney, and sheriff. No San Ramon city measure turned up in the county list reviewed. June county money offices (assessor, auditor, clerk-recorder, treasurer-tax collector, schools superintendent) were not on the November list reviewed. If one of those is on your sample ballot, this sheet did not score it.